

Vincent Van Faux



Your grievance with Grant

Grant owned an embarrassing student painting you have spent years trying to buy back. He planned to display it tonight beside your celebrated recent work as a joke about 'humble beginnings.'

Your other secret

You have secretly used buyers to acquire several of your own early paintings so you could remove them from circulation. The art world would find that both vain and market-manipulative.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself by your character name.
2. Find out whether Ella knows you were behind the anonymous buybacks.
3. Persuade Claire that the student painting should not be displayed.

If a named guest is absent, discuss that subject with anyone. These social tasks do not block the investigation.

Everything you need is here: questions, answers, preparation records, ballot and Coming Clean. Memorize your animal and return its slip. After the host announces the murderer animal, read IF MURDERER only if it is yours; otherwise read IF INNOCENT.

Questions to ask

Choose one guest named below who has not answered this round. Read the question aloud. Ignore absent guests. After answering, that guest chooses the next person. Your own answer is on the following answer page.

ASK: Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Grant wanted more control over the museum or its money. What did his plan threaten to take from you?

ASK: Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

Grant wanted the exhibition approved on his terms. What did he pressure you to sign, change or overlook?

ASK: Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

Grant was using a sale or purchase to get his way. What did he demand, and what would it cost you?

ASK: Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Grant treated the gala as his personal publicity campaign. How did he threaten your work or reputation?

ASK: Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

Grant disliked facts that made him look bad. What research, writing or correction did he want stopped?

Questions to ask

Choose one guest named below who has not answered this round. Read the question aloud. Ignore absent guests. After answering, that guest chooses the next person. Your own answer is on the following answer page.

ASK: Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Grant wanted control over what people could see or find out. What did he ask you to suppress?

ASK: Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

Grant wanted the display changed. What happened when you disagreed, and what was he threatening?

ASK: Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Grant acted as if possession settled ownership. What did he demand about the disputed objects?

ASK: Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

Grant was questioning your collection or its paperwork. What was he holding over you?

ASK: Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

Grant gave orders and expected someone else to take the blame. What did that mean for your work?

Your answer

Read the box for your role when questioned. Keep its label private. Acting is optional; these printed facts are enough.

READ ALOUD / INNOCENT OR MURDERER

Grant owned a student painting I have spent years trying to buy back. Tonight he wanted it beside my celebrated work as a joke about humble beginnings. I did not consent to being the punchline of my own exhibition.

Then choose another guest

Choose a guest who has not answered this round from either Questions to ask page. Ask one question addressed to that name. The host keeps track so everybody is heard.

Notes from this round

Questions to ask

Choose one guest named below who has not answered this round. Read the question aloud. Ignore absent guests. After answering, that guest chooses the next person. Your own answer is on the following answer page.

ASK: Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

You had business with Grant before the unveiling. When did you enter the Donor Salon, and did you borrow the conservation cabinet key?

ASK: Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

Your exhibition work took you near the salon and conservation area. When did you enter the salon, and did you borrow the cabinet key?

ASK: Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

You had gala preparations to handle. When did you enter the Donor Salon, and did you borrow the conservation cabinet key?

ASK: Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

You were preparing for the gala presentation. When did you enter the salon, and did you borrow the conservation cabinet key?

ASK: Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

You were working around the exhibition. When did you enter the Donor Salon, and did you borrow the conservation cabinet key?

Questions to ask

Choose one guest named below who has not answered this round. Read the question aloud. Ignore absent guests. After answering, that guest chooses the next person. Your own answer is on the following answer page.

ASK: Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

You were dealing with private donor arrangements. When did you enter the salon, and did you borrow the conservation cabinet key?

ASK: Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

You were helping prepare the display. When did you enter the Donor Salon, and did you borrow the conservation cabinet key?

ASK: Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

You had something to settle before the unveiling. When did you enter the salon, and did you borrow the conservation cabinet key?

ASK: Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

You were busy with your own gala errand. When did you enter the salon, and did you borrow the conservation cabinet key?

ASK: Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

You were helping the gala run smoothly. When did you enter the salon, and did you borrow the conservation cabinet key?

Your answer

Read the box for your role when questioned. Keep its label private. Acting is optional; these printed facts are enough.

IF INNOCENT

I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, asking him to withdraw the student painting. I did not go back after that. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the varnish sample stored inside.

IF MURDERER

I went into the Donor Salon at 6:44, asking him to withdraw the student painting. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the varnish sample stored inside.

Then choose another guest

Choose a guest who has not answered this round from either Questions to ask page. Ask one question addressed to that name. The host keeps track so everybody is heard.

Notes from this round

Questions to ask

Choose one guest named below who has not answered this round. Read the question aloud. Ignore absent guests. After answering, that guest chooses the next person. Your own answer is on the following answer page.

ASK: Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Even gala hosts need to clean up little disasters. What did the materials desk give you, and what did you use it for?

ASK: Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

Conservation supplies are suddenly part of this investigation. What did the desk give you, and what did you use it for?

ASK: Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

Preparing for a donor gala can be messy. What cleaning material did you receive, and what was your errand?

ASK: Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Artistic preparations can leave a mess. What did the materials desk give you, and what did you use it for?

ASK: Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

You collected cleaning supplies during setup. What were they, and what ordinary job were they meant to do?

Questions to ask

Choose one guest named below who has not answered this round. Read the question aloud. Ignore absent guests. After answering, that guest chooses the next person. Your own answer is on the following answer page.

ASK: Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

You picked up something from the materials desk. What was it, and why did you need it?

ASK: Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

You were working around the display. What cleaning material did you receive, and what did you use it for?

ASK: Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

The laboratory is comparing a thread with the setup supplies. What did you receive, and what was it for?

ASK: Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

Several guests needed something to wipe or dust with. What did you receive, and what did you use it for?

ASK: Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

Service and setup left plenty to tidy. What did the materials desk give you, and what was your job?

Your answer

Read the box for your role when questioned. Keep its label private. Acting is optional; these printed facts are enough.

IF INNOCENT

I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for cleaning a smear from my painting easel. That was what the materials desk issued me.

Preparation record:

Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry.

Conservation key book: loan at 6:06, returned and cabinet relocked.

Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam.

IF MURDERER

I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for cleaning a smear from my painting easel. That was what the materials desk issued me.

Preparation record:

Salon door register: 6:44.

Conservation key book: loan at 6:06, returned and cabinet relocked.

Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam.

Then choose another guest

Choose a guest who has not answered this round from either Questions to ask page. Ask one question addressed to that name. The host keeps track so everybody is heard.

Your ballot

Complete privately after Method. Name one suspect and explain the motive and evidence. Tear out this page or hand your closed packet to the host opened only here. Once all ballots are collected, no votes change.

Your character name

I accuse

Motive

Evidence connecting the salon, key and linen

Best Actor

Best Costume

Coming Clean

STOP: Read only after voting, when the host calls your character among the top three suspects. If no suspect confesses, the host will call the murderer animal. Everyone else keeps this page private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I used buyers to recover my own early paintings. I wanted those student works out of circulation. Vanity is an excellent motive for secrecy. My recorded salon visit ended before 6:40 and I did not return. The coupe was still clean at 6:40; I was not inside during the poisoning window. I had something to hide, but I did not murder Grant Larceny.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

Grant owned a student painting I have spent years trying to buy back. Tonight he wanted it beside my celebrated work as a joke about humble beginnings. I did not consent to being the punchline of my own exhibition. During setup I borrowed the cabinet key and took the toxin sample. At 6:44, I used the excuse of asking him to withdraw the student painting to enter the salon. I dampened my gold-seamed linen with the sample and wiped the inside of Grant's coupe and its rim. That transferred the poison. I left with the cloth. The door entry, key loan and linen receipt were all real. What I left out was what I did between them.